***Board 1***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 8 7 6
♥ 7 3
♦ K Q J 7
♣ Q 2

♠ J 5
♥ K J 2
♦ 10 9 8 2
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ 4 2
♥ A Q 10 9 8 5
♦ 5 3
♣ A 10 5

♠ K 10 9 3
♥ 6 4
♦ A 6 4
♣ K J 9 8

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♠ | 2♥ | 3♥ |
| Pass | 4♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦5

You have a limit raise in ♠s; if East had not overcalled you would have bid 3♠.

Instead, you cue-bid 3♥, promising at least 11 points and support for ♠s. Partner bids the game.

***Board 2***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 6 3
♥ A 8 7 3
♦ Q 8
♣ 8 4 2

♠ J
♥ K 5 2
♦ J 6 2
♣ K Q J 10 9 3

♠ 7 5 2
♥ Q J 10
♦ 10 9 5 4 3
♣ 7 6

♠ A 10 9 8 4
♥ 9 6 4
♦ A K 7
♣ A 5

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| 2♣ | 3♣ | Pass | 4♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣K

Partner has a limit raise or better in ♠s.

With your 17 revalued points you know that your side has at least enough for game, so bid 4♠.

***Board 3***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ A K 6 5 4
♦ A J 3
♣ 4 3

♠ A K J
♥ J 10
♦ 10 9 8 6
♣ 10 8 6 5

♠ Q 10 9 6 3
♥ 8 2
♦ 7 5 2
♣ A K 7

♠ 8 5
♥ Q 9 7 3
♦ K Q 4
♣ Q J 9 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♥ | 1♠ | 2♠ |
| Pass | 3♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

3♥ by North
Lead: ♠10

You have a limit raise in ♥s; if East had not overcalled you would have bid 3♥.

Instead, you cue-bid 2♠, promising at least 11 points and support for ♥s. Partner bids 3♥.

Pass. Partner indicates a minimum hand and you don't have enough extra to bid more.

***Board 4***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 3
♥ Q 8 7 4
♦ J 6 2
♣ 8 7 4 2

♠ K Q J 10 8 2
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 10 8 3
♣ J

♠ 7 5
♥ 9 2
♦ A K 5
♣ Q 10 9 6 5 3

♠ 9 6 4
♥ A K J 5 3
♦ 9 7 4
♣ A K

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| 1♠ | 3♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

3♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

You have a pretty good hand and if partner has a limit raise or better you should bid 4♥.

But partner doesn't have a limit raise - if he did he would have cue-bid. So you pass.

***Board 5***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 8 7 6
♥ 7 3
♦ K Q J 7
♣ 9 2

♠ J 5 2
♥ Q J 2
♦ 9 8 5 3
♣ K 5 4

♠ 4
♥ A K 10 9 8 5
♦ 10 2
♣ A Q J 7

♠ K 10 9 3
♥ 6 4
♦ A 6 4
♣ 10 8 6 3

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♠ | 2♥ | 3♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

3♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

You would have bid 2♠ if East had not overcalled.

Instead, with 4 trumps you can jump to 3♠ as a preemptive measure. Partner will not mistake this for a limit raise since you would have cue-bid with 11+ points and support.

The jump to 3 is based on the Law of Total Tricks - bidding to a trick level equal to the number of your side's trumps.

***Board 6***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 8 4 3<br>♥ K 10 6 4<br>♦ A Q 5<br>♣ Q 9 3 | |
| ♠ A K 10 9 5 2<br>♥ 8 3 2<br>♦ K<br>♣ J 7 4 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 7<br>♥ A<br>♦ 10 9 8 6 3 2<br>♣ 10 8 6 2 |
| | ♠ J 6<br>♥ Q J 9 7 5<br>♦ J 7 4<br>♣ A K 5 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| 1♠ | 2♠ | Pass | 3♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

3♥ by South
Lead: ♠K

Partner has a limit raise or better in ♥s, 11 points or more.

You, however, have a bare-bones minimum. So you rebid a minimum 3♥, which partner passes.

***Board 7***
West Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 10 9 4
♥ 8 5 3
♦ 6 5 3
♣ K 9

♠ 7 5 3
♥ A K Q 10 6
♦ J 10 2
♣ Q J

♠ 2
♥ J 9 4 2
♦ 9 8 7
♣ A 10 7 5 4

♠ Q J 8 6
♥ 7
♦ A K Q 4
♣ 8 6 3 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1♥ | 1♠ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥4

You have 14 points in support of ♠s; however, partner's overcall does not promise more than 9 points or so.

So you cue-bid 2♥, showing a good hand with support and forcing partner to bid again. Partner bids 3♠.

4♠. Partner's jump shows a good overcall, but not enough strength to insist on game when you might have only 11 points. You have plenty extra so you bid the game.

***Board 8***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ J 10 9 8<br>♥ J 9 4<br>♦ A 8 6 2<br>♣ A J | |
| ♠ 7 5<br>♥ A K Q 10 5 3<br>♦ J 10 5<br>♣ 6 4 | | ♠ 3<br>♥ 7 6 2<br>♦ 9 7 3<br>♣ 10 9 8 7 3 2 |
| | ♠ A K Q 6 4 2<br>♥ 8<br>♦ K Q 4<br>♣ K Q 5 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| 2♥ | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 6♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

Partner has a limit raise or better in ♠s, 11 points or more.

There is only one thing you want to know now - how many Aces partner holds. So you bid 4NT to find out. Partner responds 5♥.

You know you have a loser. Bid 6♠.

***Board 9***
West Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 7 4
♥ K Q J 10 2
♦ 8 7 3
♣ 10

♠ A 10
♥ 7 5 3
♦ A J
♣ K 9 7 5 4 3

♠ K 9 5 3 2
♥ 6
♦ K Q 10 2
♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 6
♥ A 9 8 4
♦ 9 6 5 4
♣ A Q J

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1♣ | 1♥ | 1♠ | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

2♥ by North
Lead: ♣2

You have 12 points in support of ♥s; however, partner's overcall does not promise more than 9 points or so.

So you cue-bid 2♣. Since the opponents have bid two suits you can cue-bid either one of them, so you usually pick the one you have the most strength in. Partner bids 2♥.

Pass. Partner had a minimum overcall so he made a minimum rebid.

***Board 10***
South Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K Q 10 6<br>♥ Q J 9 7 6<br>♦ Q J 7 5<br>♣ — | |
| ♠ J 8 5 2<br>♥ 2<br>♦ 8<br>♣ A K Q J 8 6 5 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ 9 4<br>♥ 10 4<br>♦ K 10 9 4 3 2<br>♣ 10 3 2 |
| | ♠ A 7 3<br>♥ A K 8 5 3<br>♦ A 6<br>♣ 9 7 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| 2♣ | 3♣ | Pass | 4♥ |
| Pass | 5♣ | Pass | 6♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣K

You have about 15 points in support of ♥s so you cue-bid 3♣, showing a limit raise or better and forcing partner to bid again. Partner bids 4♥.

5♣. Partner's jump shows a good hand and you have more than you have promised so far. This cue-bid is a different type, showing first round control in ♣s, Ace or void. That was apparently what partner wanted to hear since he went right to slam.